

IELTS Writing Task 2 Structure Pack

Book 1 of 5 · Plan clear Band 7+ essays in 40 minutes

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Part of the Stratum IELTS Writing Guide Series

Series map

#	Book	Focus
1	Structure Pack (this book)	Question types + paragraph system
2	Task 1 Charts Pack	Academic graphs and reports
3	Band 7 Vocabulary Pack	Safe topic words and collocations
4	Common Mistakes Pack	Grammar and logic errors
5	Essay Checklist Mini	Final checks before submit

How to use this book

1. Learn the 5 question types.
2. Memorise the 4-paragraph jobs (not whole essays).
3. Practice with the templates under timed conditions.
4. Use Book 5 checklist, then check your essay at stratumielts.com.

All explanations and sample essays in this series are **original**.

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1. What Task 2 tests

Write **at least 250 words** in about **40 minutes**.

Strong essays show:

- a direct answer to the question
- a clear position
- logical paragraphs
- mostly accurate, natural language

Band 7 idea: clear position + clean structure + controlled language.

40-minute plan

Time	Action
0–5	Type + position + 2 ideas
5–35	Write 4 paragraphs
35–40	Edit and count words

2. Five question types

Identify the type before writing.

1) Opinion

To what extent do you agree or disagree?

→ Take a clear position and support it.

2) Discussion

Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

→ Explain both sides, then give your view.

3) Advantages / Disadvantages

Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?

→ Cover both sides and answer "outweigh" directly.

4) Problem / Solution

What problems... and what solutions...?

→ Problems + realistic solutions.

5) Two-part question

Two questions in one prompt.

→ Answer **both** parts.

Rule: if the question has two tasks, your essay must cover both.

3. The 4-paragraph system

1. Introduction — paraphrase + position/preview
2. Body 1 — one main idea + explanation + example
3. Body 2 — second main idea + explanation + example
4. Conclusion — restate position, no new ideas

2-minute outline

Position: _____
 Body 1: _____
 Body 2: _____

If this is empty, do not start writing yet.

4. Templates by question type

Adapt the pattern. Do not copy robotically in the real exam.

Opinion

Intro: *[Paraphrase]. I largely agree/disagree because [1] and [2].*

Body 1: *The main reason is... This matters because... For example...*

Body 2: *Another point is... In practice... Therefore...*

Conclusion: *In conclusion, I [agree/disagree] because...*

Discuss both views + opinion

Intro: *Some people believe A, while others argue B. This essay examines both sides and explains why I support [view].*

Body 1: *View A + reason + example*

Body 2: *View B + reason + example + your opinion*

Conclusion: *Although A has some merit, I prefer B because...*

Advantages vs disadvantages

Intro: *... Although there are drawbacks, the advantages outweigh them.*

Body 1: *Main advantages*

Body 2: Disadvantages + final judgement

Conclusion: Restate which side is stronger

Problem / solution

Intro: Preview problems + solutions

Body 1: Main problems and causes

Body 2: Practical solutions and results

Conclusion: Short summary of both

5. Two sample essays

Sample 1 — Opinion

Question

Some people think unpaid community service should be compulsory in high school. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Unpaid community service is sometimes proposed as a required activity for secondary school students. I largely agree because it builds social responsibility and develops practical skills that classrooms alone rarely provide.

The main reason is that service helps teenagers understand needs beyond their own lives. Helping in libraries, care homes, or clean-ups shows how ordinary actions improve a community. For example, a student who tutors younger children may become more patient and more aware of educational gaps. As a result, civic habits form early.

A second benefit is skill development: teamwork, time management, and communication. These matter for university and work, yet many timetables focus mainly on exams. Although some families worry about pressure, schools can keep the requirement modest so study is not damaged.

In conclusion, I agree that unpaid community service should be part of high school programmes, provided the workload stays realistic.

Sample 2 — Discuss both views

Question

Some people believe higher fuel prices are the best way to cut traffic congestion. Others prefer improving public transport. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Traffic congestion is a common urban problem, and two frequent proposals are higher fuel prices and better public transport. Both can reduce car use, but I believe public transport investment is fairer and more effective long term.

On the one hand, raising fuel prices can discourage unnecessary driving. Some people may share cars or travel less. However, this can hit low-income workers hardest when they have no alternative.

On the other hand, better buses, trains, and cycling routes create real choices. When public transport is frequent and reliable, more people leave cars at home. For these reasons, I support transport investment as the main strategy, with fuel taxes only as support.

In summary, although higher fuel prices may reduce some journeys, better public transport is a more sustainable solution.

6. Practice prompts

1. Should university education be free for everyone? (Opinion)
2. Should children learn foreign languages in primary or secondary school? (Discussion)
3. Do the advantages of online shopping outweigh the disadvantages?
4. What problems does expensive housing cause, and what solutions exist?
5. Why do young people leave rural areas? Is this positive or negative?

Write one timed essay, then use **Book 5** checklist.

7. Next step

- Need chart language? → **Book 2: Task 1 Charts Pack**
- Need better wording? → **Book 3: Vocabulary Pack**
- Keep making the same errors? → **Book 4: Mistakes Pack**
- Ready to submit? → **Book 5: Checklist Mini**

Then paste your essay into the **Stratum IELTS Writing checker** at <https://stratumielts.com> for feedback.

About this booklet

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End of Book 1 — Structure Pack · stratumielts.com